

# Erasmus+ Traineeship Project Management Report

## Introduction

My name is Brandyvie Mbuyi Mayobo and this my final report on the ASPM project for the Erasmus+ traineeship. As a third-year Software Development student, I am preparing for a potential Erasmus+ traineeship in January 2027. The purpose of this project was to research suitable international internships and prepare myself for the complete process, from identifying suitable opportunities to preparing applications, interviews, cultural changes, accommodation, transport and living costs. I used Scrum as the project management methodology because it allowed me to divide a large project into smaller and achievable tasks. I organised the work into four sprints, with each sprint having a specific goal and set of deliverables. This approach helped me track my progress and ensured that all the important areas of Erasmus+ preparation were covered.

## Research and Pre-Planning

The first stage of the project involved researching the ErasmusIntern website for suitable traineeship opportunities. I focused on internships related to Software Development and Game Development and considered the assignment requirements, particularly the requirement for a placement lasting between three and six months. Although some internships did not have a January 2027 start date, the assignment allowed the start date to be disregarded.

After researching different opportunities, I selected three internships that were relevant to my studies and career interests. The first was a **Full-Stack Developer internship with PRIOT Digital Systems in Maribor, Slovenia**, with a duration of five months. It involves areas such as frontend and backend development, databases, APIs, Git and software development. The second was a **Game Development Intern position with JP IT Solutions & Consulting in Kavala, Greece**, lasting three months. It focuses on game development, Unreal Engine, C/C++/C#, gameplay, level design, 3D and prototyping. The third was a **Software Development & Hardware Integration Trainee position with BMI Leisure in Geel, Belgium**, with a minimum duration of three months. This position involves C#/.NET, software development, testing and integration with hardware such as RFID systems and karting timing systems.

I compared these internships based on duration, technical requirements, relevance to my degree, location, working arrangements, financial considerations and opportunities for professional development. PRIOT was the strongest overall match for general Software Development, JP IT Solutions was particularly suitable because of my interest in game development, while BMI Leisure offered a different opportunity to develop software and hardware integration skills.

Before beginning the main work, I created an initial product backlog. The backlog contained tasks including researching internships, selecting three opportunities, researching the companies, comparing requirements, preparing my CV and portfolio, preparing applications, researching interview questions, investigating cultural differences, researching accommodation and transport, estimating living costs and producing the final report. Each backlog item also had a Definition of Done so that I could clearly identify when a task was completed.

## Sprint 1 – Research and Internship Selection

The first sprint focused on **research and pre-planning**. I searched ErasmusIntern and initially considered several potential opportunities before selecting the three most suitable internships. I recorded the company names, countries, locations, duration, technical requirements and relevance to Software Development.

I also researched the companies themselves rather than relying only on the internship descriptions. PRIOT Digital Systems develops digital solutions involving areas such as web and mobile applications, AI, IoT and digital systems. JP IT Solutions & Consulting works across IT and software development and offers a game development opportunity involving Unreal Engine and game-production activities. BMI Leisure develops software for family entertainment centres and go-karting businesses, including point-of-sale, booking, timing and RFID-related systems.

The Definition of Done for Sprint 1 required me to identify appropriate internships, verify their duration and requirements, record their locations and technical skills, research the companies and document why each opportunity was suitable. I also saved the relevant source information. Completing this sprint gave me a clearer understanding of the opportunities and allowed me to move into the application stage with better knowledge of what employers were looking for.

## Sprint 2 – Application Preparation

Sprint 2 focused on preparing the materials that would be required when applying for the internships. I updated my CV to highlight my Software Development education, technical skills, projects and relevant work experience. I also created an Erasmus portfolio that included examples of my academic and technical work, including my **Book Collection Management project, LEGO full-stack website and horror game design project**.

I then compared my existing skills with the requirements of each internship. My experience with JavaScript, HTML, CSS, SQL, databases, Git/GitHub and full-stack development provides a strong foundation for the PRIOT position. My experience with C++, C#, programming and game design is relevant to JP IT Solutions. My knowledge of C#, Java, Object-Oriented Programming, testing and debugging is useful for the BMI Leisure position.

I also prepared a general application checklist and cover-letter structure. The purpose was to ensure that each application could be tailored to the specific company instead of sending an identical application to every employer. I identified technical areas that I would need to

improve. For example, Vue.js, Nuxt.js, Python and ASP.NET would be useful for the PRIOT position, while Unreal Engine and Blender would be valuable for the game development position. For BMI Leisure, I would benefit from further knowledge of .NET and hardware integration.

This sprint demonstrated the importance of comparing my current skills with employer requirements before applying. It allowed me to identify development goals rather than simply focusing on the skills I already possess.

## **Sprint 3 – Interview and Cultural Preparation**

Sprint 3 focused on preparing for potential interviews. I created a set of twenty general and technical interview questions. These covered introducing myself, explaining previous projects, Object-Oriented Programming, databases, APIs, frontend and backend development, Git/GitHub, debugging, testing and programming languages.

I also prepared internship-specific areas. For JP IT Solutions, I would expect questions about game development, C++/C#, Unreal Engine and game design. For PRIOT, I would prepare for questions relating to full-stack development, databases, APIs and web technologies. For BMI Leisure, I would prepare for questions involving C#, .NET, testing and communication between software and hardware.

For behavioural questions, I planned to use the STAR method: Situation, Task, Action and Result. I also prepared questions that I could ask employers at the end of interviews. This is important because asking relevant questions demonstrates preparation and genuine interest in the company.

Cultural research was also included in this sprint. Slovenia, Greece and Belgium have different workplace expectations. Slovenian workplaces can place importance on preparation, professionalism and respectful communication. Greek workplaces can place greater emphasis on personal relationships and social interaction. Belgian workplaces generally emphasise professionalism, cooperation, responsibility and following agreed procedures.

I would therefore need to remain open-minded when working abroad. Instead of assuming that colleagues would communicate or work in exactly the same way as people in Ireland, I would observe their working practices, ask questions and adapt appropriately. I would also learn basic phrases in the local language to make everyday communication easier.

## **Sprint 4 – Accommodation, Travel and Financial Planning**

The final sprint focused on practical preparation. I researched potential accommodation in each internship location. In Maribor, University of Maribor student accommodation was the preferred option because it is designed for students and can be relatively affordable. Private shared accommodation was considered as an alternative. In Kavala, a furnished student room or shared apartment would be appropriate for a three-month internship because it

could reduce costs and provide flexibility. In Geel, student accommodation such as Kot66, Studentenkamers Wens and other student-room listings were considered.

I also researched travel and local transport. For Maribor, travelling through Ljubljana or Graz and then using bus or train connections would be practical. Kavala has an international airport and local bus services, making buses and taxis useful for travelling around the area. Geel is connected to the Belgian railway network, while buses and cycling can be useful for local journeys.

Living costs were estimated to help determine the financial requirements of each option. My planning budget was approximately **€550–€650 per month for Maribor, €700–€800 for Kavala and €800–€900 for Geel**. These estimates included accommodation, food, transport, phone/internet and personal expenses. I would also need an emergency fund for accommodation deposits, travel, household items and unexpected costs.

## Scrum Reflection and Conclusion

Using Scrum made the Erasmus+ preparation project more organised because I could divide the work into four clear stages instead of attempting to complete everything simultaneously. The product backlog provided a list of tasks that needed to be completed, while the Definition of Done provided a clear standard for determining whether each task was finished. Each sprint had a specific focus, allowing me to gradually build the project from initial research through to practical preparation.

One area I would improve in future is recording my actual time more consistently. Although I estimated the work required for different backlog items, more detailed time tracking would make it easier to compare estimated and actual effort. I would also divide some larger backlog items into smaller tasks earlier in the project. This would make progress easier to measure and help identify delays sooner.

Overall, this project has given me a realistic understanding of the preparation required for an Erasmus+ traineeship. I identified three potential internship opportunities, researched the companies and their work, prepared my CV and portfolio, investigated interview requirements, researched cultural differences and considered accommodation, transport and living costs. The project also demonstrated how Scrum can be applied outside a traditional software development project. By using a product backlog, sprint planning, Definitions of Done and a retrospective approach, I was able to manage my Erasmus+ preparation in a structured and measurable way. The next step would be to continue developing the technical skills relevant to each internship and tailor my applications before submitting them.